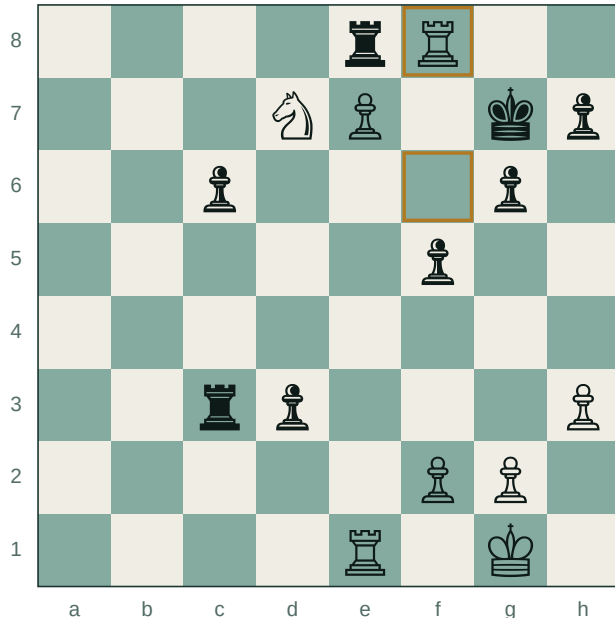


Pins and pressure: Black, move 34

Pins and pressure

Black to move



Previous move: 34.Rf8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

34...d2 35. Rd1 Rc1 36. Kh2 Rxd1

34...d2 The pawn moves from d3 to d2. Recorded reply: **35.Rd1**.

35...Rc1 The rook moves from c3 to c1. Recorded reply: **36.Kh2**.

36...Rxd1 The rook captures the rook on d1.

At the end, nominal material is White 12 / Black 15 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -2 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A pinned piece can sometimes move along the line, capture the pinning piece, or answer with a forcing resource.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pin limits a piece because moving it exposes a more important target. A pin to the king restricts legality; a pin to another piece changes the practical cost of moving.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the line through attacker, pinned piece, and rear target. Test whether the pinned piece is being counted as a defender it cannot really be.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: knight on d7 and rook on e1. Check for tactical protection.